20.5.2 Choosing a response format with content negotiation

Content negotiation is where a client says which types of data it can accept using the `Accept` header and the server picks the best one it can handle. Generally speaking, this works as you'd hope: the server formats the data using a type the client can understand.

The ASP.NET Core implementation has some special cases that are worth bearing in mind:

- By default, ASP.NET Core returns only `application/json`, `text/plain`, and `text/html` MIME types. You can add `IOutputFormatters` to make other types available, as you saw in the previous section for `text/xml`.
- By default, if you return `null` as your API model, whether from an action method or by passing `null` in a `StatusCodeResult`, the middleware returns a `204 No Content` response.
- When you return a `string` as your API model, if no `Accept` header is set, ASP.NET Core formats the response as `text/plain`.
- When you use any other class as your API model, and there's no `Accept` header or none of the supported formats was requested, the first formatter that can generate a response is used (typically JSON by default).